



Irish regimental flag

The Union's Irish Brigade was composed initially of New York regiments, later joined by units from Pennsylvania and Massachusetts, including the 28th Massachusetts, a Boston regiment, whose flag is shown here.

Ethnic regiments in action

By the end of 1862, the German and Irish regiments had earned different reputations in the Northern public's eye. Valiant assaults on the Sunken Road at Antietam and Marye's Heights at Fredericksburg had earned the Irish Brigade a badge of courage that persists in the public imagination even to this day. But plundering in the Shenandoah Valley Campaign of 1862, caused by inadequate provisioning by the Federal War Department, had given Blenker's Germans a different report. Labeled "Hessians," "Dutchmen," or "Blenkerites," the Germans labored under a false reputation for